MENTORSHIP

REQUIREMENT FORM

EduNeuro

Submission to IIT Guwahati Technology Incubation Centre (TIC)

Founder: Sumanta
Entity: EduNeuro
Stage: Open Beta / Pre-Incubation
Document Date: September 2026
Classification: Confidential

This document details the specific mentorship areas and support required by EduNeuro during its incubation period at IIT Guwahati Technology Incubation Centre. All information is confidential.

1. Startup Name

EduNeuro — AI-Native Study Orchestration and Learning Platform

2. Founder

- **Name:** Sumanta
- **Background:** Student researcher working in Artificial Intelligence
- **Role:** Founder and primary operator
- **Contact:** [TO BE FILLED]

3. Startup Stage

Open Beta / Pre-Incubation. EduNeuro is currently operating in an open beta phase. The core platform is under active development. Early user validation signals are encouraging but product-market fit has not been achieved. The venture has not received external funding, has zero paying users, and is self-funded at the founder level.

4. Brief Description

EduNeuro is developing an AI-native study orchestration platform for competitive examination preparation. The platform's core thesis is that students need not more educational content, but an intelligent system that continuously understands their learning state — their knowledge, gaps, behaviour, and progress — and recommends the most valuable next learning action. The initial market wedge is GATE (Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering) preparation in India. The platform is designed to generalise across examinations and learning contexts once the core orchestration technology is validated.

5. Problem Being Addressed

Students preparing for competitive examinations use multiple disconnected tools for different aspects of their preparation. These tools are optimised for individual activities rather than the student's entire learning process. The result is that students know what they studied but cannot confidently answer:

- What should I study next?
- Which weak areas need targeted attention?
- Am I actually improving?
- How does my study behaviour affect outcomes?
- When should I revise?
- Is my study plan working?

EduNeuro addresses this by building a unified, AI-driven system that models the learner continuously and orchestrates the complete preparation journey.

6. Proposed Solution

An AI-native study orchestration platform that integrates learning support, study planning, practice, assessment, focus management, and progress tracking around a longitudinal learner model. The platform uses AI to reason about the learner's current state and recommend the next best action, with the system becoming more personalised and effective over time as it accumulates learner data.

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7. Current Progress

Product Development:

- Open beta platform with core capabilities in active development
- GATE syllabus mapping in progress across major branches
- AI tutoring, study planning, practice engine, and analytics modules under development

User Validation:

- 500+ sign-ups / expressions of interest
- 50+ current DAU (recent measurement)
- Peak of ~400 daily users observed during early launch period
- 505 website visitors, 3,093 page views (cumulative, early beta)
- 200,000+ organic content reach; 150,000+ organic content views
- 2.6 lakh+ Instagram content views (organic)
- User research conducted via survey instruments

Operational:

- Self-funded at founder level
- Zero paying users; no external funding raised
- Founder-led development with lean operational model

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8. Key Challenges

- **Product-Market Fit Validation:** Moving from early traction signals to demonstrable product-market fit requires focused user research, rapid iteration, and structured experimentation.
- **AI Content Quality:** Ensuring that AI-generated educational content is accurate, pedagogically sound, and aligned with examination requirements is a critical challenge that requires robust evaluation frameworks.
- **Learner Model Design:** Designing a multi-dimensional learner state model that is both computationally tractable and genuinely useful requires expertise in learning science, AI systems, and educational product design.
- **Retention:** Keeping students engaged with the platform over the long preparation■■ (often 6–18 months) requires sustained value delivery and habit-forming product design.
- **Team Scaling:** The founder-led model is insufficient for scaling. Recruiting and integrating technical, content, and community talent is a priority.

- **Monetisation:** Pricing strategy and freemium conversion mechanics require careful validation with the target demographic.
- **Competitive Landscape:** Established players have significant brand recognition and content resources. EduNeuro must differentiate on system-level value rather than feature parity.
- **Responsible AI Deployment:** Deploying AI in an educational context requires careful attention to content accuracy, learner data privacy, transparency, and potential negative impacts on learning autonomy.

9. Mentorship Required (Overview)

EduNeuro requires structured mentorship across six interconnected areas. Each area is detailed in the following sections.

- Technical Mentorship (Section 10)
- Product Mentorship (Section 11)
- Business Mentorship (Section 12)
- Market / GTM Mentorship (Section 13)
- AI/ML Research Guidance (Section 14)
- Incubation and Ecosystem Support (Section 15)

10. Technical Mentorship

EduNeuro requires technical mentorship in the following specific areas:

- **Scalable AI Architecture:** Guidance on designing and deploying AI services that can scale from hundreds to tens of thousands of users while managing API costs, latency, and reliability.
- **Learner Modelling Systems:** Expertise in designing multi-dimensional learner state models, including knowledge tracing, mastery estimation, and behavioural pattern recognition.
- **Recommendation and Personalisation:** Guidance on building recommendation systems that can determine the optimal next learning action for each individual learner based on their state model.
- **AI-Generated Content Evaluation:** Frameworks and methodologies for evaluating the accuracy, pedagogical quality, and examination-relevance of AI-generated educational content.
- **Evaluation and Experimentation:** Designing rigorous A/B testing and experimentation frameworks to measure the platform's impact on learning outcomes.
- **Technical Scalability:** Guidance on infrastructure scaling, database design for longitudinal learner data, and performance optimisation.
- **Security and Data Governance:** Best practices for securing learner data, implementing privacy-preserving architectures, and ensuring compliance with data protection regulations.

11. Product Mentorship

- **GATE Use Case Definition:** Identifying the strongest, most differentiated use case within the GATE preparation market — the one feature or workflow that creates the most compelling reason for students to adopt the platform.

- **User Experience Design:** Guidance on designing intuitive, engaging workflows for complex study orchestration tasks. The product must simplify the student's life, not add another tool to manage.
- **Retention and Engagement:** Strategies for maintaining student engagement over long preparation cycles (6–18 months). Understanding habit formation, motivation design, and re-engagement mechanics.
- **Learning Outcome Measurement:** Defining and implementing metrics that credibly measure the platform's impact on learning effectiveness — not just engagement, but actual improvement in test performance and knowledge retention.
- **Feature Prioritisation:** Making disciplined decisions about which features to build first, based on user value, technical feasibility, and strategic importance.
- **User Research Design:** Structuring user research programmes that generate actionable insights about student needs, pain points, and feature preferences.

12. Business Mentorship

- **Monetisation Validation:** Designing and executing experiments to validate freemium pricing, willingness to pay, price sensitivity, and conversion mechanics among the target demographic.
- **Customer Segmentation:** Identifying distinct user segments within the GATE aspirant population and tailoring product positioning and features accordingly.
- **Business Model Refinement:** Evaluating and refining the subscription model, exploring potential B2B/institutional opportunities, and assessing alternative revenue streams.
- **Go-to-Market Strategy:** Developing a structured GTM plan that builds on the content-driven organic approach while identifying scalable acquisition channels.
- **Institutional Partnerships:** Guidance on approaching and structuring partnerships with coaching institutions, universities, and student bodies.
- **Startup Operations:** Advice on lean operations, financial management, accounting practices, and building operational infrastructure appropriate for the current stage.
- **Fundraising Readiness:** Preparing for pre-seed/seed fundraising — pitch development, investor targeting, financial modelling, and term sheet negotiation.
- **Legal and Compliance:** Guidance on entity formation, intellectual property strategy, terms of service, privacy policies, and regulatory compliance.

13. Market and GTM Mentorship

- **GATE Market Understanding:** Deep insights into the GATE preparation ecosystem — student demographics, coaching landscape, decision-making factors, and unmet needs.
- **Competitive Positioning:** Guidance on positioning EduNeuro against established players (Unacademy, BYJU'S, Gradeup, Testbook) and emerging AI tools, identifying the messaging that resonates with the target audience.
- **Customer Acquisition Strategy:** Advice on scaling the content-driven organic acquisition approach, identifying high-impact content formats and distribution channels.

- **Community Building:** Strategies for building and nurturing a community of GATE aspirants around the platform, creating organic advocacy and retention.
- **Geographic Targeting:** Insights into regional differences in GATE preparation behaviour and how to tailor the platform for different geographic segments of the Indian market.
- **Brand Development:** Guidance on building a credible, trusted brand in the education technology space — particularly important for a platform using AI in a context where accuracy and reliability are paramount.

14. AI/ML Research Guidance

- **Learning Science Integration:** Guidance on integrating evidence-based learning science principles — spaced repetition, retrieval practice, interleaving, metacognitive scaffolding — into the platform's AI architecture.
- **Adaptive Learning Models:** Research guidance on state-of-the-art adaptive learning algorithms, knowledge tracing methods (e.g., Bayesian Knowledge Tracing, Deep Knowledge Tracing), and their application to examination preparation.
- **Student Modelling:** Expertise in designing learner state models that capture knowledge, behaviour, and affective states, and using these models to drive personalisation.
- **Educational AI:** Guidance on the emerging research in AI for education, including large language model applications, AI tutoring systems, and learning analytics.
- **Experimentation and Evaluation:** Designing rigorous research studies to evaluate the platform's impact on learning outcomes, including control group design, statistical methods, and causal inference approaches.
- **Responsible AI:** Guidance on responsible deployment of AI in educational contexts, including content accuracy assurance, algorithmic transparency, bias detection, and learner autonomy preservation.
- **Content Generation Quality:** Research approaches to evaluating and improving the quality of AI-generated educational content, including factual accuracy, pedagogical soundness, and examination alignment.
- **Research Collaboration:** Opportunities for collaborative research with IIT Guwahati's faculty and research groups, potentially leading to publications, grant opportunities, and academic credibility.

15. Incubation and Ecosystem Support

- **Mentor Matching:** Structured matching with mentors across technology, product, business, and research domains.
- **Peer Network:** Access to a community of fellow founders and startups at IIT Guwahati TIC, enabling peer learning, collaboration, and support.
- **Investor Access:** Structured introductions to angel investors, micro-VCs, and institutional investors relevant to edtech and AI startups.
- **Industry Connections:** Access to industry experts, potential customers, and strategic partners through IIT Guwahati's network.

- **Research Community:** Engagement with IIT Guwahati's research community, including potential collaborations with faculty and access to student researchers.
- **Talent Pipeline:** Access to IIT Guwahati students and alumni for internships, full-time roles, and co-founder-level partnerships.
- **Legal and Administrative:** Support with entity formation, IP management, compliance, and administrative requirements.
- **Infrastructure:** Co-working space, computing resources, and shared services that reduce operational overhead.
- **Programme Structure:** Access to TIC's structured incubation curriculum, including workshops, masterclasses, pitch sessions, and milestone reviews.
- **Credibility:** Association with IIT Guwahati's brand to support customer trust, investor confidence, and partnership negotiations.

16. Expected Outcomes from Mentorship

EduNeuro expects the following concrete outcomes from the incubation programme:

- **Product-Market Validation:** Clear evidence of product-market fit or a well-reasoned pivot decision within 6–9 months, supported by structured user research and quantitative engagement metrics.
- **Technical Maturity:** A production-ready platform with validated AI architecture, content quality assurance, and scalable infrastructure.
- **Monetisation Validation:** A validated pricing strategy and freemium conversion model with at least initial revenue traction (target: [TO BE FILLED] paying users within incubation period).
- **Team Formation:** A founding team expanded to include at minimum a technical co-lead and one dedicated content/resources role.
- **Fundraising Readiness:** A compelling pitch, financial model, and investor pipeline that enables a successful pre-seed/seed round following or during the latter phase of incubation.
- **Research Output:** At least one collaborative research output (paper, conference submission, or technical report) arising from the learner modelling and AI architecture work.
- **Community and Brand:** A recognised brand within the GATE preparation community and a growing, engaged user base (target: [TO BE FILLED] total users by end of incubation).
- **Expansion Readiness:** A documented, validated plan for expanding to JEE and NEET, with the technical and content architecture prepared for multi-examination support.

These outcomes represent EduNeuro's best-effort projections based on current trajectory and will be refined in consultation with TIC mentors throughout the incubation period.

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Date:	September 2026

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